



GENERAL ENGLISH

TREND ANALYSIS

(2016-2014)

S.No.	Chapter Name	2016 (I)	2015 (II)	2015 (I)	2014 (II)
1	Synonym	9	15	8	12
2	Antonym	-	10	7	8
3	One Word Substitution	-	-	5	-
4	Sentence Arrangement (S ₁ -S ₆)	10	-	10	8
5	Sentence Arrangement (PQRS)	15	-	7	11
6	Spotting Error	15	15	20	25
7	Cloze Test	20	25	20	20
8	Suitable Word Selection	10	10	-	-
9	Question Based on Comprehension	21	20	23	16
10	Sentence Improvement	20	25	20	20
Total		120	120	120	120

01

SPOTTING THE ERRORS

Generally, 15 to 20 questions based on spotting the errors are asked in CDS exam. In these type of questions, the given sentences are divided into three parts with each part marked as (a), (b) and (c). We have to choose that part as our answer which has error. If there is no error in any part, then we have to choose option (d) as the answer.



‘Spotting the errors’ or ‘Syntax’ is that part of English language, where the grammatical skills of the candidates are comprehensively tested. Therefore, it can be said to be the most important part of the language proficiency test.

It is an integrated grammar exercise, so it covers all the grammatical parts. *This includes*

- Parts of speech
- Number, gender, cases and degrees
- Confusing words
- Uses of tenses
- Non-finites
- Determiners and articles

All these areas are to be studied thoroughly to score high in the CDS examination.

FORMAT OF THE QUESTIONS

Each question consists of a complex sentence, which is divided into **three parts**. One of the parts may contain an **error**. The candidate has to spot the error and mark the incorrect option/part. In case, there is no error in the sentence, option (d), which stands for ‘No error’, needs to be selected.

An example of this type of question is given below.

Direction Which part of the following sentence contains an error? In case there is no error, choose option (d).

Question The train should arrive at 7:30 in the morning but it was almost an hour late No error
(a) (b) (c) (d)

Ans. (a) In the given sentence, option (a) is given as ‘The train should arrive’ while the correct sentence is ‘The train should have arrived’. Here ‘should arrive’ should be replaced by ‘should have arrived’. So, **option (a)** has an error.

NOUN

A word that refers to a person, place, thing, event, substance or quality is called a Noun.

e.g. Ram, Delhi, Book, Lion, Street, etc.

Kinds of Noun

- 1. Common Noun** It is a name given to every person or thing of the same class or kind.
e.g. - Boy, girl, fan, chair, etc.
- 2. Proper Noun** Details of a common noun are signified by proper noun.
e.g. - Amit, Amita, Polar fan, Supreme chair, etc.
- 3. Material Noun** It refers to a material or substance from which things are made such as silver, gold, iron, cotton, diamond and plastic.
- 4. Collective Noun** Some nouns refer to groups of people (e.g. audience, team, committee, government etc). These are called as Collective Nouns.
- 5. Abstract Noun** It is the name of a feeling, quality or a state.
e.g. - *Feeling* Love, fear, hate, anger, respect, pleasure, etc.
- *Quality* Strength, pitch, innocence, gluttony, judgement, obedience, beauty, etc.
- *State* Weariness, mercy, birth, death, etc.

Number of Nouns

There are two kinds of nouns of number, which are as follow

Singular Noun It refers to one (single) person or thing.
e.g. - boy, girl, table, man, etc.

Plural Noun It refers to more than one person or things.
e.g. - boys, girls, tables, men, etc.

- Sometimes plurals are made by changing the inside vowel.

Singular	Plural
Man	Men
Woman	Women
Foot	Feet
Tooth	Teeth
Mouse	Mice

- Sometimes plurals are made by adding 's' to the principal word of a compound noun. e.g.

Singular	Plural
Brother-in-law	Brothers-in-law
Vice-Admiral	Vice-Admirals
Court Martial	Courts Martial
Commander-in-chief	Commanders-in-chief
Runner-up	Runners-up
Looker-on	Lookers-on

- Some other examples are as follow

Singular	Plural
Ox	Oxen
Datum	Data
Medium	Media
Stratum	Strata
Index	Indices
Formula	Formulae
Lacuna	Lacunae
Alumnus	Alumni
Corrigendum	Corrigenda
Erratum	Errata
Syllabus	Syllabi

- Nouns like sheep, deer, offspring, cod, fish, salmon, etc have the same form in both the numbers.

Rules of Noun

- Articles are not used before material nouns.
e.g. - *The* leather is used in making shoes. (X)
- Leather is used in making shoes. (✓)
- Material nouns and abstract nouns are not used in plural.
e.g. - *Cares* of the old is necessary. (X)
- *Care* of the old is necessary. (✓)
- Proper nouns are sometimes used as common nouns.
e.g. - Samudragupta is *the* Napoleon of India.
- Kalidas is *the* Shakespeare of India.
In these two sentences, the proper nouns Napoleon and Shakespeare are used as common nouns.
- Collective nouns usually take a singular verb and are substituted by a singular pronoun.
e.g. - The jury *has* given *its* verdict.
- The team *has* performed to *its* potential.
- Collective nouns takes a plural verb and are substituted by a plural pronoun when the group members do not behave as a whole but take different directions.
e.g. - The jury ~~is~~ / *are* divided in ~~its~~ / *their* decision.
- The Ministry *are* much divided in *their* opinion regarding the foreign policy.
- Collective nouns**, even when they denote living beings, are considered to be of neuter gender.
e.g. - India has a big army and *it* is divided into three major divisions.
- Young children and animals are also referred to as neuter gender.
e.g. - The baby started crying when *it* was hungry.
- The lizard lost *its* tail when *it* was frightened.

8. When objects without life are personified, they are considered either masculine or feminine gender.

Masculine Gender is used for strength, violence, anger and vengeance. It is used with Sun, Death, Summer and Winter.

- e.g. - Nature has taken *his* vengeance by claiming lives of 100 persons.
- The sun, with *his* brilliance, came out of the clouds.

These sentences emphasise the strong masculine traits of nature and the sun i.e. 'vengeance' and 'brilliance', so the masculine gender 'his' is used.

Feminine Gender is used for beauty, gentleness and gracefulness. It is used with Earth, Moon, Spring, Nature and even for Sun.

- e.g. - Nature offers ~~its~~ / *her* lap to those who seek it.
- The sun, with *her* warmth, provided relief from the bitter cold.

In the above sentences, the tender feminine traits of nature and the sun are revealed, so the feminine gender (her) is used.

9. Units of counting, i.e., pair, dozen, score, hundred, thousand, etc, when used after numbers retain their singular form.
- e.g. - Ten pair, Five dozen, Two score, Six hundred, Three thousand, One lakh, Ten crore, Eight million, Ten billion, etc.
- e.g. - My friend bought two *dozen* / ~~dozens~~ eggs from the market.
- Here, the quantity is mentioned before the dozen, so we have its singular form.
- e.g. - My friend bought *dozens* of eggs from the market.
- Here, the quantity is not mentioned in the above sentence, so we use the plural form 'dozens'. One more example is
- e.g.
- Sunil Gavaskar scored *thousands* of runs in his cricketering career.
10. In a compound noun, a compound word is not used in plural if a noun does the work of an adjective.
- e.g. - He is pursuing a two year/~~years~~ diploma course.
- He is a fifteen year/~~years~~ old boy.
 - I have got a hundred rupee/~~rupees~~ note.
 - He ran a five mile/~~miles~~ race.
 - They went on a fifteen day/~~days~~ tour.

11. The following nouns are used only in plural.

- Names of instruments, which have two parts forming a kind of pair. Like scissors, spectacles, glasses, tongs, etc.
e.g. - Scissors *are* / ~~is~~ used to cut.
- My pair of spectacles *is* very expensive.
In the above sentence, we use singular form 'is' as the word 'pair' is added before the word 'spectacles'.
- Certain articles of dress as trousers, shorts, jeans, etc.
e.g. - Jeans *are* in vogue these days.
- Certain collective nouns (although they are singular in form). Police, cattle, gentry, peasantry, clergy, people, poultry, majority, artillery, infantry, etc.
e.g. - Police *have* reached the crime scene.
- Cattle *are* grazing in the field.
- Certain other nouns are thanks, assets, premises, alms, proceeds, contents, refreshments, orders, repairs, requirements, rations, statistics (*collection of data*), credentials, etc.
e.g. - Court should make it mandatory for the ministers to declare their *assets*.
- Alms *were* distributed among the beggars.

12. Some plural forms are commonly used in singular like Mathematics, Statistics, Physics, Economics (*All subjects*), Gymnastics, News, Innings, Series, Measles, Rabies, Mumps, Rickets, Summons, Names of Books, etc.

13. Uncountable nouns are used in the singular forms only. Indefinite article (a, an) is not used before them, nor are they (a, an) used with plural verbs. 'Much' is used in place of 'Many' for denoting plurality.

Some of the important nouns of this category are as follow

Advice, information, hair, luggage, business, work, word (promise), mischief, bread, scenery, abuse, vacation, evidence, employment, alphabet, poetry, furniture, baggage, trouble, fuel, wheat, rice, stationary, etc.

- e.g. - (a) He gave me *an* information. (X)
He gave me information. (✓)
- (b) You should be true to your *words*. (X)
You should be true to your word. (✓)
- (c) He was punished for committing *many* mischiefs. (X)
He was punished for committing *much* mischief. (✓)